Ricks College
Course Outline

Financial Accounting 201, **Sections 2, 3, & 5** **Winter Semester, 2001**
Instructor: Keith Patterson, CPA **Office**: Smith 485 **Hours:** 11-12:00 MWF
Phone: Office 356-1452 2-3:00 MWF
Home 356-9658 1-2:00 W
Or by appointment
e-mail address: pattersonk@ricks.edu

Credit Hours: 4.0

Required Text: Financial Accounting, 7th edition, by Warren/Reeve/Fess and supplement.

Prerequisites: Generally, students should have attained Sophomore status and have maintained a 2.5 GPA prior to enrolling in this course.

Course Description & Objectives:
A. Description - This rigorous course provides a basic foundation for other courses in accounting as well as in business and information processing. The course is generally accepted by most colleges and universities through transfer credit. The course will consist of lectures and discussions relative to text assignments and problems, emphasizing basic accounting theory and practices. Homework will be reviewed in class so that students may check their work and questions can be discussed and answered.

B. Objectives:

1. Develop an understanding of and ability to work with accounting principles relative to the theory of debit and credit; the worksheet; financial statements; payroll; journalizing; posting; special journals and ledgers; negotiable instruments; adjusting, closing and reversing procedures; assets valuation; and corporate accounting.
2. Develop an understanding of the accounting cycle and to analyze transactions and apply them to the cycle and to compile financial statements and interpret from the contents.
3. Provide the foundations for advanced work in accounting and business related subjects. (Accounting is the language of business.)
4. Develop a working vocabulary of accounting terminology.
5. Gain exposure to the ethical responsibility of accountants and to emphasize writing skills for accountants.
6. Gain exposure to accounting/business sites on the Internet and to develop interactive skills by working in groups.

Grading:

93 - 100% = A	73 - 76% = C	Homework	100
90 - 92% = A-	70 - 72% = C-	Exams (4)	400
87 - 89% = B+	67 - 69% = D+	Final Exam	150
83 - 86% = B	63 - 66% = D	Quizzes (drop 1)	75
80 - 82% = B-	60 - 62% = D-	Class Attendance	20
77 - 79% = C+	Below 60% = F	Group Activities	25
		Ethics Write-ups	30
(Grades may be curved if necessary.)		Total Points	800

Homework: Homework is essential to developing a working understanding of accounting. Be prepared to spend many hours in solving homework problems. Time and effort are just as important as the correct solution. Accounting is something that usually has to be experienced to gain the most from it, although some memorization is essential, too. One cannot learn to play the piano by merely reading and memorizing from a book. Accounting works the same way. For most chapters, students should expect to spend a minimum of 4 to 6 hours working on their homework assignment. With the exception of a few problems that will be done on working papers, homework will be done on regular notebook paper. Homework is due at the end of class on the last day spent on each chapter, unless otherwise directed by your instructor. Homework is to be done in pencil, with any subsequent corrections made in class to be done in ink. This allows the instructor to see the efforts made out of class and to evaluate student progress. Student errors will automatically be highlighted in ink for your preparation for exams. Also, initial solutions should be attempted in pencil as erasures are common in accounting. An assignment sheet will be given for Monopoly at a later time. For the Study Guide assignment, students will read "A Study Guide For Accounting Students" handout and will type a one-half page summary of something they learned, or of something they think will help them from that handout.

Problem Assignments:

A Study Guide for Accounting Students

Chapter	1 - 1,4,5	**Chapter**	8 - Ex19,1,2,3,5
	2 - 2,4,5		9 - 1,2,3,4,5
	3 - 1,2,4		10 - 1,3&SYD,4,5,6
	Appendix C - Ex1,Ex2,Ex3,Ex4		11 - 1,2,5,6
	4 - 3,Comprehensive Prob. 1		12 - 1,3,4,5
	5 - 1,3,5		13&App E - 1,3,4,ApE P1
	6 - 3,4,7		14 - 2&6,3&7,4,5
	Appendix D - P2,P3,P4		Monopoly assignment
	7 - 1,2,3,5		

All homework is made up of problems, unless Ex precedes the problem number, in which case, the assignment is an exercise. All problems are from the "A" group only, except for the Appendix problems, comprehensive problem, Study Guide, and Monopoly assignment. Accuracy, neatness, and completeness will be considered when grading homework. Each chapter assignment is worth 10 points total regardless of how many problems are assigned. If the '**&**' symbol appears between two problems, they are to be done together as if they are one problem. The Monopoly assignment is worth 20 points. The Study Guide assignment is worth 5 points. Homework will be accepted late with maximum point allocations as follows:

Up to one class period late - 80%
Up to two class periods late - 70%
Up to three class periods late - 60%
None accepted after three class periods.

Students should make every effort to stay caught up. Those who intend to be out of town when homework is due should turn it in prior to departure or make other arrangements to have it turned in by a friend. No late penalty will be applied when the student is ill; write ill on top of your homework when turning it in. Please have your name on all homework sheets and have the sheets arranged in proper numerical order according to the problem numbers. Homework assignments will be graded by a student grader. If a student disagrees with his/her score, please contact the instructor. The instructor will frequently examine homework, too, in order to monitor student progress and grader thoroughness.

To obtain a semester homework score the following formula is used:

$$\frac{\text{"X"}}{185} \times 100$$

where "X" will be the sum of the student homework scores for the semester out of the 185 points (14 chapters; Appendix C; Appendix D, 10 points each; Study Guide write-up, 5 points; and Monopoly, 20 points). One-hundred points are available in calculating the final grade.

Exams: Four regular exams will be given as well as a final exam. The exams consist of multiple choice questions and work problems. Both subjective and objective content is provided on the exams to test student memory, understanding, and ability to analyze and apply concepts covered in class. The final is 1/3 comprehensive to test student retention of previously covered topics. Students should read each question carefully and should attempt to answer all problems on the exam. With the exception of the final, all exams will be administered at the testing center. Although no time limit penalties will be assessed, students should be aware that speed is important too, not just accuracy. (The CPA exam is a timed exam.) Therefore, the student should learn to pace him/her self throughout the exam. Each student is responsible for taking the exams at the testing center during the allotted time. **Be sure you allow yourself sufficient time to complete each one.**

Quizzes: Quizzes are used as stepping stones in helping students prepare for exams. A quiz will be given each chapter and appendix, after the homework has been discussed, for a total of 16 with 10 points for each quiz. The lowest quiz score will be dropped to leave 150 points. **There will be no make up on missed quizzes, except for illness or a college approved absence.** A missed quiz may, however, count as the low score that is dropped. Since only 75 points are used in the final grade calculation, the following formula is applied to arrive at a semester quiz score:

$$\frac{\text{"X"}}{150} \times 75$$

"X" represents the sum of the quiz scores for the student for the semester.

Class Attendance: In order to gain the full benefit of the instructor and peer interaction, class attendance is expected. Students who fail to attend class fail to do well in accounting courses. One-half point is deducted for each class period missed that we meet. College excused absences or illness will not cause you to lose points. I must see the college absence form **before** you miss class in order for you to be excused. If you cannot attend due to illness, you must notify me **before** class. You may leave a message on my answering machine. In the event of an emergency, you may notify me after class. Two tardies will count as one absence. You are tardy if you come in after the opening prayer. Attend regularly and on time.

Group Activities:
Accountants and other business people are expected to regularly work with a variety of individuals in groups or in teams. Five group activities will be assigned during the course by the instructor. Students will work on these activities in groups of three or four people. The groups will be established by the instructor at the beginning of the semester. It is expected that all group members will actively participate together with their group. Each group activity is worth 5 points. Most of these activities will involve the use of the Internet. If your group activity is done and turned in on time, it will earn the full 5 points. Late group activities will be accepted, but will be assessed a penalty equal to that of late homework.

Ethics Write-ups: One of the biggest complaints against recent accounting and business graduates is their inability to express themselves in writing. Accountants are frequently called upon to express opinions and findings in an accurate, clear, thorough, and concise manner. Because accountants subject themselves to a code of professional conduct, students should be exposed to ethics in the accounting curriculum. Students will be expected to write three papers discussing ethics or accounting ethics cases provided by the instructor. Each write-up should be one to one-and-a-half pages in length. They should be typed with proper attention given to grammar, spelling, organization, and clarity of expression. They will also be graded on the soundness and thoroughness of the content. These are formal papers and should be treated as such. Here is a chance for students to interrelate their English course skills with ethics in the accounting area. Each write-up is worth 10 points. Late papers will be assessed a penalty equal to that of late homework, so make sure yours are turned in on time.
Instructor Expectations: Students are expected to come to class prepared each time. Chapters should be read, homework done, questions formulated, etc. for each appropriate class period.

Heber J. Grant said, "*It is not what you eat that benefits you, but what you digest. What you hear today is of no use to you less you put it into practice. Somebody has said, and I have often repeated it: 'Knowledge without practice is like a glass eye--all for show and nothing for use'."*
Students are expected to meet the objectives as set forth at the beginning of each chapter in the textbook and to stay caught up. Getting behind in accounting is usually devastating to the student's progress and grade. Regular attendance is expected and common courtesies to fellow classmates should be shown at all times. **Students are asked to refrain from visiting with their classmates during class time.** (See D & C 88:122). Honesty and integrity are expected--no cheating will be tolerated. **Students are expected to abide by the college honor and dress code.** Please remember that each of you voluntarily signed your name in consent to abide by this code. If you have any questions or concerns, please feel free to discuss them with me or look them up on the Ricks College Internet site.

Student Helps: The following should be recognized as helps available to the students to assist in succeeding in the course.

Instructor: Please see me. Office hours were mentioned earlier and are posted on my door. Other appointments can be made if necessary. Call me at home if you really get stuck and need some explanation and help. Send me an e-mail if that is convenient.

Textbooks: Use the textbook to its fullest potential. Underline key statements. Follow and work through the examples given. Work extra exercises or problems from the book. Other textbooks may also shed some light on a given problem or subject and are available at the library.

Mortimer Adler said, "*Why is marking up a book indispensable to reading? First, it keeps you awake. (And I don't mean merely conscious; I mean wide awake.) In the second place reading, if it is active, is thinking, and thinking tends to express itself*
in words, spoken or written. The marked book is usually the thought-through book. Finally, writing helps you remember the thoughts you had, or the thoughts the author expressed." He further stated, "*You buy a steak..., but you do not own the steak in the most important sense until you consume it and get it into your bloodstream. I am arguing that books, too, must be absorbed in your bloodstream to do you any good."*

If you need help in learning how to properly use a textbook and how to mark it up, the Reading Lab in MK E 230 is available free of charge. The Study Skills Lab offers free assistance also. It is located in MK E 200. The bookstore also has accounting aids that may be purchased, including a student study guide written specifically for this book. The study guide can be purchased on-line, one chapter at a time for $1.49 + tax per chapter, by going to http://echapters.swcollege.com.

Fellow Students: Group learning can be beneficial. Form study groups if you wish. You have a built in study group, if you choose to use it, because of the group activities discussed previously. Be willing to share your knowledge if someone asks you a question. Explaining something to someone else helps reinforce what you already know. Students who have previously completed the course may be able to offer you some help, too.

Class: Attend regularly and on time. Take good, accurate, readable notes. Refer to the examples in the notes. Follow the lecture. Ask questions if you do not understand.

Lab: An accounting lab is available free of charge so that students may get extra help. It is

located in room 383 of the Smith Building and is open as follows:

Mondays and Fridays 4:00 to 6:00 p.m.
Tuesdays - Thursdays 4:00 to 7:00 p.m.

Video Cassette Tapes: There are various video cassette tapes prepared to supplement the textbook that can be viewed. Please see me to check them out.

Tutoring Center: Students who need help beyond their regular classroom instruction may seek free assistance at the tutoring center. This should be used only as a final measure of obtaining help. Students are encouraged to explore the other helps first. The tutoring center is located in MK E 204.

Disability Statement: In compliance with applicable disability law, qualified students with a disability may be entitled to "reasonable accommodation." It is the student's responsibility to disclose to the teacher any special need she/he may have before the end of the first week of class.

Use the helps that are available to you. They are here to help guarantee your success in this course. Accounting is a very rigorous course, yet can be very rewarding for the willing student. The handout "A Study Guide for Accounting Students" is also provided for your benefit.

The following represents a tentative schedule for the class. The instructor reserves the right to make changes, deletions, corrections, or additions during the course. Adequate notice will be given of any changes.

Jan. 9 T Course outline
11 Th Chapter 1 - **Introduction to Accounting and Business**, **Study Guide Summary due**
12 F Chapter 1
15 M **Human Rights Day**
16 T Chapter 1, **Ethics #1 due**
18 Th Chapter 1
19 F Chapter 2 - **Analyzing Transactions**
22 M Chapter 2
23 T Chapter 2
25 Th Chapter 3 - **The Matching Concept and the Adjusting Process**
26 F Chapter 3, Appendix C - **Alternative Methods of Recording Deferrals**
29 M Chapter 3, Appendix C
30 T Appendix C

Feb. 1 Th Chapter 4 - **Completing the Accounting Cycle**
2 F Chapter 4**, Group Activity #1 due**
5 M Chapter 4
6 T **Exam I opens--**Chapters 1-4, Appendix C
8 Th Chapter 5 - **Accounting Systems and Internal Controls**
9 F Chapter 5, **exam I closes**
12 M Chapter 5
13 T Chapter 6 - **Accounting for Merchandising Businesses**
15 Th Chapter 6**, Group Activity #2 due**
16 F Chapter 6, Appdx D - **Periodic Inventory Systems for Merchandising Businesses**
19 M **Presidents Day**
20 T Appendix D
22 Th Chapter 7 - **Cash**
23 F Chapter 7, **Ethics #2 due**
26 M Chapter 7
27 T **Exam II opens--**Chapters 5-7, appendix D

Mar. 1 Th Chapter 8 - **Receivables**
2 F Chapter 8; **Exam II closes**
5 M Chapter 8**, Group Activity #3 due**
6 T Chapter 8
8 Th Chapter 9 - **Inventories**
9 F Chapter 9
12 M Chapter 9
13 T Chapter 10 - **Fixed Assets and Intangible Assets**
15 Th Chapter 10
16 F Chapter 10, **Group Activity #4 due**
19 M Chapter 10
20 T **Exam III opens--**Chapters 8-10
22 Th **Business Summit**
23 F Chapter 11, **Current Liabilities**; **exam III closes**
26 M Chapter 11
27 T **Monopoly** (I'll be gone to a seminar at USU)
29 Th **Spring Break**

30 F **Spring Break**

Apr. 2 M Chapter 11

3 T Chapter 12 - **Corporations:Organization, Capital Stock Transactions, & Dividends**

5 Th Chapter 12; **Ethics #3 due**

6 F Chapter 12

9 M Chapter 12

10 T **Exam IV opens--**Chapters 11 & 12

12 Th **Monopoly**

13 F Chapter 13 - **Corps: Income Taxes, Stockholders' Equity, & Investments in Stocks**
Exam IV closes

16 M Chapter 13 & Appendix E - **Foreign Currency Transactions**

17 T Chapter 13 & Appendix E

19 Th Chapter 14 - **Bonds Payable & Investments in Bonds**; **Monopoly assignment due**

20 F Chapter 14

23 M Chapter 14, **Group Activity #5 due**

24 T Chapter 14

Final Exam--

Section 2, Thursday, Apr. 26th, 9:10 to 10:40 a.m. only!

Section 3, Thursday, Apr. 26th, 12:30 to 2:00 p.m. only!

Section 5, Friday, Apr. 27th, 12:30 to 2:00 p.m. only!

2/3 of the final covers Chapters 13-14 and 1/3 is comprehensive.

HAVE A WONDERFUL SUMMER!!!!